# IT Support Guide

Version 5.1 | Effective 1 March 2026 | Owner: IT Service Desk

## 1. Getting Help

The IT Service Desk is available Monday to Friday from 07:30 to 18:00. Raise a ticket through the service portal, email it-help@acme.example, or call extension 4100. For a critical outage affecting many users, always call extension 4100 rather than emailing.

## 2. Priority Levels and Response Times

Every ticket is given a priority that sets how quickly it is handled.

P1 Critical means a system is down for all users. The Service Desk responds within 15 minutes and aims to resolve the issue within 4 hours.

P2 High means a major function is unavailable for a team. Response is within 1 hour and resolution within 8 hours.

P3 Normal means an issue affecting one user, usually with a workaround. Response is within 4 hours and resolution within 3 working days.

P4 Low means a request or minor issue. Response is within 1 working day and resolution within 10 working days.

## 3. Password Policy

Passwords must be at least 14 characters long and must be changed every 90 days. The last 10 passwords cannot be reused. An account is locked after five failed sign-in attempts.

Locked accounts can be unlocked through the self-service portal, or by the Service Desk after your identity has been verified. Never share your password with anyone, including IT staff.

## 4. Multi-Factor Authentication

Multi-factor authentication (MFA) is mandatory for email, the VPN and the HR portal. Use the company-approved authenticator app on your phone.

If you lose your phone or it is stolen, contact the Service Desk immediately. A temporary bypass code, valid for 24 hours, can be issued once your identity is confirmed.

## 5. VPN and Remote Access

Staff working remotely must connect to the company VPN before using internal systems such as the file server or the finance application. The VPN client may only be installed on company-managed devices. Personal devices may access web email only.

## 6. Laptops and Equipment

New equipment is requested by the line manager through the service portal. Standard-issue laptops are replaced every three years.

If a company device is lost or stolen, report it to the Service Desk and to security@acme.example within two hours so that it can be remotely locked and wiped. Lost devices must also be reported to the police and the report number supplied to IT.

## 7. Software Installation

Only software from the approved Software Catalogue may be installed. Requests for other software must be approved by IT Security, who will assess licensing and security risks. Unlicensed or pirated software is strictly prohibited.

## 8. Backups and File Recovery

Files saved on network drives and in the company cloud storage are backed up every night. Files saved only on a laptop are not backed up. Deleted files can be restored for up to 30 days after deletion by raising a P3 ticket.

## 9. Reporting Phishing

Do not click links or open attachments in suspicious emails. Forward the email as an attachment to security@acme.example and then delete it.

If you have already clicked a link or entered your password, change your password and call the Service Desk on extension 4100 immediately.